

Tobias Treppmann

Design systems shaped by how the organization actually works

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · design systems built to stay intact under AI-assisted work · governance and contribution paths · motion carried as shared easing curves

Interaction and visual design

Data-dense analytical interfaces · honest feedback for sampled and approximate data · availability and booking logic shaped by progressive disclosure and error prevention · color in OKLCH with contrast held in light and dark mode · theming across iOS, Android, web and connected TV · Selah, a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store, down to the icon and the store listing

Accessibility

an accessibility audit under the European Accessibility Act · WCAG contrast checked in code · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · alt text generated at platform scale, across six countries

Building and tools

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · SwiftUI · React and web · Claude Code and Zed as daily tools · Storybook and component specifications engineering can build from without a Figma seat

Governance and strategy

Tools, governance and workflows · integrating new technology into how a team works · design strategy tied to business and product goals · change management across functions · mentoring designers outside a reporting line

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where I built the design system from scratch — a four-tier token architecture made to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source. Nobody who builds with it reports to me. Engineering sits at external agencies and product managers set direction, so the system has to enforce itself. An enumerated token vocabulary makes the compliant path the fast one for a product manager and for an AI assistant alike. The build rejects what does not come from it. I owned the design system at Ninox and defined component architecture at Datameer before that.

Enforced in the build

checks in CI refuse a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written straight into a component

Accessibility in code

WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm, and an EU Accessibility Act audit that covered the sites customers build

Interaction, visual, system

a query builder honest about sampled data · a color engine holding contrast in light and dark · the token architecture under both

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Won the agency over to a change that costs them billable work — type size, spacing and radius moved into the token API, so product teams adjust them without a ticket.
- Standardization and flexibility hold apart by architecture, not by policy. Component and view tiers alias down to the primitives, so a team moves without moving the foundation.
- One Storybook, and everyone builds from it: the agency, product managers, an AI assistant.
- A prototyping layer sits on top of the real components, light and dark, phone through TV. A product manager assembles a screen from the system instead of describing one.
- The build catches what a reviewer cannot — CI rejects a token reference that does not resolve and a color written in by hand. Neither shows up as a visual difference.
- Contrast is decided inside the algorithm, not by a later check. The color engine builds themes from program artwork and validates WCAG contrast as it goes.
- Built Color Lab, which tunes that engine. The thresholds and the normalization curves are dials, not commits.
- Bet on light mode against the streaming default — the brand is warm, not cinema black. In validation 87% preferred it, at 4.2 out of 5 for premium feel (n=40).
- Prototyped on Android, where most of the userbase is. Web was faster and would have answered the wrong question.
- Engineering ships from my prototype code, written against real production APIs. The engineers are an outside agency.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Made an accessibility law survivable for the customers it landed on — churches run their websites on our platform, and the European Accessibility Act gave them a legal deadline.
- What we shipped met it for them automatically, across six countries under GDPR plus church data-protection law, covering every site customers build with the platform.
- Built a booking system for complex processes with rotating availabilities — finding a priest for a funeral.
- The same build then carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings. At the launch customer, coordination time fell 70%, at 90% acceptance.
- Held product management for the platform beside all of its design. That is why the booking architecture was mine to decide, and mine to take to the customer.
- Designed the booking to offer only what was actually bookable — the rules of 20-plus cemeteries, buffer times and Outlook availability resolved before a slot appears, not after the click.
- Specified components so engineering never had to guess: interaction behavior written out, token-based naming, redlined measurements in plain text beside the Figma file.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Owned the design system, and built the governance around it — a standing working group with engineering and four designers, with an escalation path, so decisions held after I left the room.
- Designed the components, not only the system around them: navigation, modals, and the multi-select searchable dropdowns a no-code platform needs on almost every screen.
- Motion lives in the design system, not per screen: custom easing curves, defined once.

Research and validation

Validation surveys against old and new designs · internal usability testing with follow-up interviews · iterative screening on usertesting.com to reach people inside regulated banks · Dovetail as a research repository · Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment and recurring pain points

- For four months I ran design and product at once — nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Turned a services business into a product catalog, with the executive team of a listed group.
- Ran the design-thinking training for that leadership team.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved, and built the ones a data product needs — what each guaranteed and where it could be used, down to table column headers and inspector panels.
- The hardest interaction problem on the platform: big-data queries ran on samples, so a preview could show nothing while every matching row was there. I designed the feedback that said so.
- Built the dense surfaces a data platform lives on: column charts, big-data pivot tables, an aggregated JSON structure view, result cards and the filter system.
- One interface for business users, analysts and data engineers — the same screens had to serve people who never write a query and people who write nothing else.
- Got inside banks that let no vendor watch them work.
- Executive-sponsored site visits, and iterative screening on usertesting.com to reach analysts the panels could not.
- Five years leading the design team across Germany and NYC.

INDEPENDENT PRACTICE · ORATIO&CO, 2016 – PRESENT

A consulting and product practice that has run alongside every employed role since 2016.

AI Product Design program

2026 – Present

A curriculum, a Claude Code skill that critiques a designer's work and prepares them for interviews, and the coaching framework around both. In beta with a first student, after the school they were enrolled at closed mid-course.

AI onboarding for Ninox

Summer 2025

Prompt-to-database onboarding with split-screen direct manipulation, designed with the CEO and technical co-founder. It became the basis for the public AI beta.

Bibel TV, connected TV apps

Before the contract

Product consulting for their connected-TV apps — a human-centered perspective, a UX audit and a competitive audit. Product strategy consulting followed, a few months before I joined full time.

Enterprise UX for Software AG

Earlier

Design-thinking methods applied to a large B2B software platform.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · CareerFoundry · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

Mentor · Interaction Design Foundation · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · Spreadshirt · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA